

THE RIG VEDIC AGE (EARLY VEDIC)

RIG VEDA AS SOURCE → SAPTA-SINDHU TEXTUAL GEOGRAPHY → KIN POLITY: AUTHORITY WITHOUT → CATTLE-AGRICULTURE ECONOMY LOOP → SOCIETY: KINSHIP, DIFFERENCE AND → DEITIES, RITA, YAJNA AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g10 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

STAGE 00 RIG VEDA AS SOURCE AND CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

RIG VEDA AS SOURCE AND CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION EARLIER CORE TRENDS VARIED/LATER MATERIAL DISCIPLINED TRANSMISSION WORKING EARLY VEDIC HORIZON BROADLY C. 1500-1000 BCE, NOT A DATE FOR EVERY

TEXT GIVES A POETIC-RITUAL WORLD; FREQUENCY AND SILENCE ARE

FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) → OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) → REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION earlier core

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) → OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) → REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION earlier core trends varied/later material disciplined transmission
- Working early Vedic horizon: broadly c. 1500-1000 BCE, not a date for every hymn.

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MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- Text gives a poetic-ritual world, frequency and silence are not census data.
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IMPACT / LIMIT

- Working early Vedic horizon: broadly c. 1500-1000 BCE, not a date for every hymn.
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MECHANISM / VERDICT → Text gives a poetic-ritual world; frequency and silence are not census data.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Text gives a poetic-ritual world; frequency and silence are not census data.

STAGE 01 SAPTA-SINDHU TEXTUAL GEOGRAPHY

SAPTA-SINDHU TEXTUAL GEOGRAPHY NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU KABUL/KUBHA → INDUS/SINDHU → PUNJAB RIVERS → SARASVATI/DRISHADVATI ZONE RIVERS ORGANISE PRAISE, MOVEMENT, PASTURE AND CONFLICT; GEOGRAPHY IS GANGA IS MARGINAL IN THIS HORIZON; LATER VEDIC EXPANSION

DO NOT TURN REMEMBERED RIVERS INTO PRECISE POLITICAL BORDERS.

Kabul/Kubha → Indus/Sindhu → Punjab rivers → Sarasvati/Drishadvati zone mountain routes trunk river pastoral/farming eastern

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU
- Kabul/Kubha → Indus/Sindhu → Punjab rivers → Sarasvati/Drishadvati zone mountain routes trunk river pastoral/farming eastern attention

NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU

Rivers organise praise, movement, pasture and conflict; geography is selective.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Rivers organise praise, movement, pasture and conflict; geography is selective.
- Ganga is marginal in this horizon; later Vedic expansion shifts the centre east.

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DEBATE / LEGACY

- Do not turn remembered rivers into precise political borders.
- NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU

MECHANISM / VERDICT → Do not turn remembered rivers into precise political borders.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Do not turn remembered rivers into precise political borders.

STAGE 02 KIN POLITY: AUTHORITY WITHOUT TERRITORIAL STATE

KIN POLITY AUTHORITY WITHOUT TERRITORIAL STATE WAR LEADERSHIP, PROTECTION, DISTRIBUTION AND RITUAL STATUS; NOT ABSOLUTE SMALLER/SELECT ASSEMBLY CONTEXT BROADER ASSEMBLY PUROHITA MARTIAL ROLE GROUP LEADER

OFFERING/TRIBUTE, NOT A REGULAR LAND-REVENUE BUREAUCRACY

KULA → GRAMA → VIS → JANA

RAJAN: war leadership, protection, distribution and ritual status; not absolute monarch sabha: smaller/select assembly context

samiti: broader assembly purohita: adviser

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- KULA → GRAMA → VIS → JANA
- RAJAN: war leadership, protection, distribution and ritual status; not absolute monarch sabha: smaller/select assembly context
- samiti: broader assembly purohita: adviser

senani: martial role

gramani: group leader

balli: offering/tribute, not a regular land-revenue bureaucracy

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- senani: martial role
- gramani: group leader
- balli: offering/tribute, not a regular land-revenue bureaucracy

senani: martial role

gramani: group leader

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Power rested on kin support, cattle, gifts, assemblies and successful leadership.

MECHANISM / VERDICT → Power rested on kin support, cattle, gifts, assemblies and successful leadership.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Power rested on kin support, cattle, gifts, assemblies and successful leadership.

STAGE 03 CATTLE-AGRICULTURE ECONOMY LOOP

CATTLE-AGRICULTURE ECONOMY LOOP PASTURE + WATER CATTLE WEALTH DAIRY, TRACTION, GIFTS, STATUS AND CONFLICT MIXED FARMING BARLEY/YAVA + CULTIVATION + CRAFTS + EXCHANGE + HOUSEHOLD PASTORAL PREDOMINANCE DOES NOT MEAN ABSENCE OF AGRICULTURE OR

PASTURE + WATER → CATTLE WEALTH → dairy, traction, gifts, status and conflict mixed farming

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- PASTURE + WATER → CATTLE WEALTH → dairy, traction, gifts, status and conflict mixed farming: barley/yava + cultivation
- + crafts + exchange + household production mobility and raiding settlement and seasonal cropping

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PASTORAL PREDOMINANCE DOES NOT MEAN ABSENCE OF AGRICULTURE OR

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.
- PASTURE + WATER → CATTLE WEALTH → dairy, traction, gifts, status and conflict mixed farming: barley/yava + cultivation

Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- + crafts + exchange + household production mobility and raiding settlement and seasonal cropping
- Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.

MECHANISM / VERDICT → Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Pastoral predominance does not mean absence of agriculture or exchange.

STAGE 04 SOCIETY: KINSHIP, DIFFERENCE AND PROJECTION LIMITS

KINSHIP, DIFFERENCE AND PROJECTION LIMITS HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER PATRILINEAL MARRIAGE PATRON-CLIENT DASA/DASYU STATUS GROUPS TENDENCY PURUSHA SUKTA IS LATE IN THE CORPUS; LATER JATI HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER PATRILINEAL MARRIAGE

HOUSEHOLD/KIN ORDER patrilineal marriage patron-client dasa/dasyu status groups tendency alliances gift ties varied terms priests/warriors/commoners

Purusha Sukta is late in the corpus; later jati cannot be back-projected.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

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STAGE 05 DEITIES, RITA, YAJNA AND SOMA

DEITIES, RITA, YAJNA AND SOMA ORDERED TRUTH AND COSMIC-SOCIAL REGULARITY PRAISE + OFFERING + PRIESTLY SPEECH PROTECTION, CATTLE AND VICTORY RELIGION LINKS ECOLOGY, WARFARE, GIFT ECONOMY AND ORDER; TEMPLES

RITA: ordered truth and cosmic-social regularity

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DEITIES: Indra-war/rain

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- RITA: ordered truth and cosmic-social regularity
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YAJNA: praise + offering + priestly speech → protection, cattle and victory

RELIGION LINKS ECOLOGY, WARFARE, GIFT ECONOMY AND ORDER; TEMPLES

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- YAJNA: praise + offering + priestly speech → protection, cattle and victory
- Religion links ecology, warfare, gift economy and order; temples are not central.

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DEBATE / LEGACY

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- DEITIES: Indra-war/rain

MECHANISM / VERDICT → Religion links ecology, warfare, gift economy and order; temples are not central.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Religion links ecology, warfare, gift economy and order; temples are not central.

STAGE 06 CONFLICT, TECHNOLOGY AND CULTURAL INTERACTION

CONFLICT, TECHNOLOGY AND CULTURAL INTERACTION HORSE/CHARIOT + BOWS/WEAPONS + MOBILE WAR BANDS CATTLE RAIDS TEXTUAL CHARIOT TERMS MATTER; ARCHAEOLOGICAL CORRELATION REMAINS INDEPENDENT. PRESTIGE CONTACT AND INCORPORATION

horse/chariot + bows/weapons + mobile war bands cattle raids + route/pasture contests + Dasharajna coalition

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- horse/chariot + bows/weapons + mobile war bands cattle raids + route/pasture contests + Dasharajna coalition conflict leadership and
- prestige contact and incorporation

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TEXTUAL CHARIOT TERMS MATTER; ARCHAEOLOGICAL CORRELATION REMAINS INDEPENDENT.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.
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MECHANISM / VERDICT → Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.

STAGE 07 EARLY TO LATER VEDIC TRANSFORMATION

EARLY TO LATER VEDIC TRANSFORMATION EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC NORTH-WEST/SAPTA-SINDHU UPPER GANGA-YAMUNA AND EASTWARD CUMULATIVE TRANSFORMATION WITH REGIONAL VARIATION, NOT ABRUPT RUPTURE.

RATNINS CATTLE-CENTRED MIXED ECONOMY PLOUGH AGRICULTURE, SURPLUS AND CRAFTS

EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership janapada, stronger monarchy and

ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid differentiation firmer varna/patriarchy and gotra deity praise and

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

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yajna royal ritual and Upanishadic questioning

VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- yajna royal ritual and Upanishadic questioning
- VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

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DEBATE / LEGACY

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MECHANISM / VERDICT → VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

STAGE 08 RIG VEDIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

RIG VEDIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE 10 MARKS SOURCE CAUTION HYMN TERM 15 MARKS ARCHAEOLOGY CAUTION 20 MARKS KIN SYSTEM

10 MARKS: source caution → institution/economy → hymn term → qualification

15 MARKS: geography → polity → economy → society → religion → archaeology caution

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 10 MARKS: source caution → institution/economy → hymn term → qualification
- 15 MARKS: geography → polity → economy → society → religion → archaeology caution

20 MARKS: corpus/layers → Sapta-Sindhu → kin system → cattle-agriculture loop

differentiation → ritual worldview → conflict/contact → transition

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 20 MARKS: corpus/layers → Sapta-Sindhu → kin system → cattle-agriculture loop
- differentiation → ritual worldview → conflict/contact → transition

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AVOID: nomad-only, caste-complete, state/empire or homogeneous-date claims.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- AVOID: nomad-only, caste-complete, state/empire or homogeneous-date claims.
- CLOSE: a layered pastoral-agricultural kin society undergoing differentiation.

MECHANISM / VERDICT → source caution → institution/economy → hymn term → qualification.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE → WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: source caution → institution/economy → hymn term → qualification.

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT → ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT OPTIONAL ADVANCED ORIENTATION → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] A1. TEXTUAL STRATIFICATION AND ORAL-FORMULAIC METHOD → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] A2. GIFT ECONOMY AND REDISTRIBUTION → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

A3. INDO-IRANIAN RELIGIOUS COMPARISON → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] A4. DASA/DASYU, VARNA AND BOUNDARY-MAKING → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] A5. HOUSEHOLD, GENDER, FUNERAL AND PHILOSOPHICAL MATERIAL → [OPTIONAL] A6. ARCHAEOLOGY, HORSE AND CHARIOT LIMITS → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Optional Advanced Orientation → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A1. Textual Stratification and Oral-Formulaic Method → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A2. Gift Economy and Redistribution → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A3. Indo-Iranian Religious Comparison → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

ADVANCED DEBATE

- A4. Dasa/Dasyu, Varna and Boundary-Making → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A5. Household, Gender, Funeral and Philosophical Material → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A6. Archaeology, Horse and Chariot Limits → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A7. Historical Memory and Historiography → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Advanced Evidence Clinics: Applying the Limits → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Optional Advanced Orientation → [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] The following material enriches the core session but is not required for
- a competent Prelims or Mains answer.
- Oral stability can preserve archaic language, while composition and transmission still create layers.

OPTIONAL STATUS → This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.